



>>We need freedom to change service providers>>

>>Harish Pillay, Global Community and Technology Architect, Red Hat

What is Red Hat's role in PaaS?

There have been attempts at PaaS (Platform as a Service), but none of them were truly open-source in nature. We felt the need to define this space. OpenShift is everything that goes into the middleware. As a developer you can develop your application in the language you choose using a whole range of frameworks.

What are some points to ponder over regarding the cloud?

I believe there's no point talking about moving to the cloud, if it is not clear how you would leave the cloud. So I think what's more important is what the exit strategy would be from your current cloud service provider to another. That's really the question to ask, else you'll be stuck with the provider you opt for without a strategy in place when you need to change. We all need flexibility and freedom to change cloud service providers.

Is OpenShift modular in approach?

There are two terms we use in OpenShift. We have something called a Gear and something called a Cartridge. So yes, it is modular in the sense that everything is a gear. You can have a MySQL Gear, a PostgreSQL Gear. You could have different types of Gears to provide specific capabilities.

Is there any significant product or company that has developed anything on OpenShift?

There is a very popular online IDE called Cloud9 (c9.io). It is built using OpenShift and enables developers to develop apps that actually run on OpenShift which is very interesting. >

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